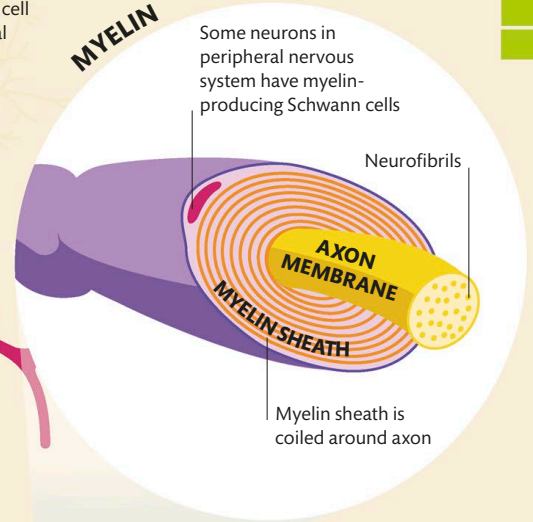
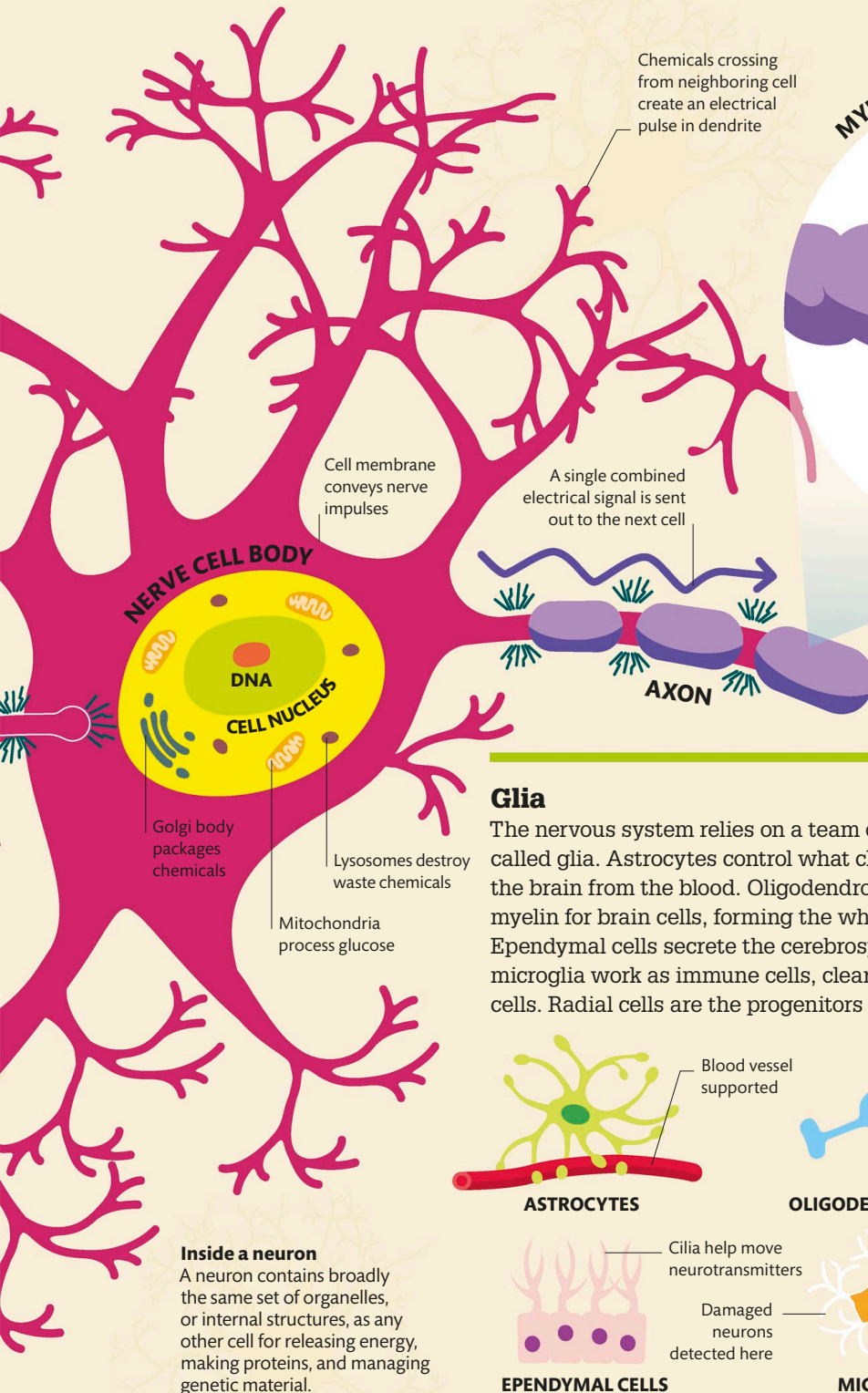




Insulation

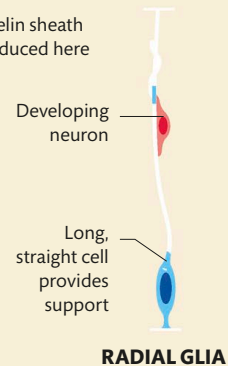
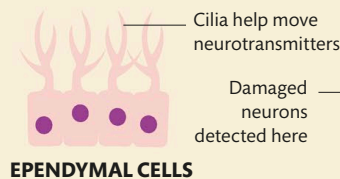
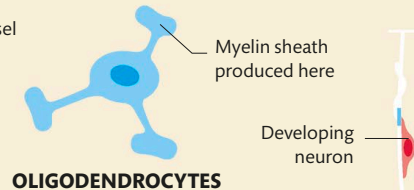
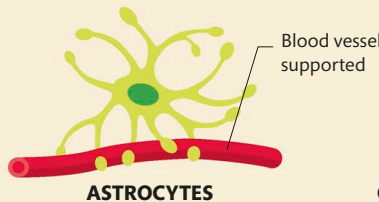
An axon may be covered in a sheath of fat called myelin. This works like insulation, preventing electrical charges from leaking out and thus speeding up the signal.

Glia

The nervous system relies on a team of helper cells called glia. Astrocytes control what chemicals enter the brain from the blood. Oligodendrocytes produce myelin for brain cells, forming the white matter. Ependymal cells secrete the cerebrospinal fluid, while microglia work as immune cells, clearing out waste cells. Radial cells are the progenitors of neurons.

Helper cells

There are eight main types of glia, but only five are common in the brain. They protect the overall health of the nervous system.



Inside a neuron

A neuron contains broadly the same set of organelles, or internal structures, as any other cell for releasing energy, making proteins, and managing genetic material.